North London Girls' Schools' Consortium Group 2: 11+ English Paper 2014

School: The North London Independent Girls' Schools' Consortium Group 2
Subject: English (Part A Reading)
Level: 11+
Time: 45 mins
Type: Past Test Paper
Year in use: 2014

Part A

search

Q	Sample Answers	Action
1.	Alice is Lilly's sister and Jez is Alice's boyfriend.	
2.	This suggests that it is being used as a weapon or deterrent.	
3.	The punctuation creates a lazy atmosphere in two ways. Firstly, the use of commas makes the sentence feel like a list. The list of activities are very relaxing and so the reader is encouraged to picture a slow peaceful experience. This is then followed by a very short sentence that draws particular attention to another activity; cloud-watching. This reinforces the idea that this is a tranquil place where time is not measured.	
4.	Lilly dislikes above Jez for ... • being friendly towards their family pet. Lilly believes that he is only doing this to gain the affection of the rest of the family. Lilly mistrusts him at this point. • calling her 'Sweetie' instead of using her real name. Lilly seems insulted by his use of affectionate terms. • talking too much during the car ride in an attempt to gain the affections of the rest of her family. • being greedy when he reaches for the picnic basket. • Jez's name, appearance and choice of clothing.	
5.	This word suggests that they are strong and relatively still. It also has connotations associated with sail boats.	
6.	The swans have such an impact on Lilly because • they are so unified, unlike her own situation. She draws comparisons between the swan family and her own • Lilly may be slightly jealous of the swans because Lilly's family are described as " a less unified family group." • Lilly also finds hope in the cygnets who are relatively ugly compared to their parents. She likes the idea that they evolve into something so beautiful. Perhaps she hopes that this can be true for her and/or her family members.	

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7.	understanding of animals. • He jumbles the dog who he pets his stomach, suggesting that he knows that dogs enjoy this. • When they all notice the injured cygnet, Jez makes a confident assessment of the situation saying "It'd need a vet, and soon." However, when he does decide to try to help, he seems to know how to manage the animals, for example, when the parent bird defends the young, Jez "calmly gathered its body into his arms, hugging it almost," showing that he understands how to handle animals. • When picking up the cygnet, he folds "its wings close against its body." This shows that he knows how not to further injure the bird. • Once he has the bird on land, he knows how to calm it down. He puts it into his t-shirt and assures the others "once it can't see it'll calm down." He is correct as the bird "relaxed and the panting stopped." • When he says "The RSPCA have specialist vets", it shows that he is aware that vets have specialisms and that this animal will require care from one of them.
8.	Lilly was wrong about several things. For example, Lilly complains about is the weather being too hot for a picnic. By the end of the extract, Lilly has decided that she was wrong about that and enjoys the sun. Furthermore, Lilly's initial assessment of Jez had been wrong. Lilly made assumptions about Jez, suggesting that he was greedy and didn't fit in with her family. She was suspicious of him and upset that the rest of the family believed that he was a good person. However, she decides that all of these assessments were wrong after Jez proves himself to be a caring animal lover.
9.	Lilly does this as a peace offering. She uses the cakes as a way to demonstrate that she likes Jez now and the cakes give her a way to show that she now accepts him. It marks the beginning of a fresh start and her new attitude towards Jez.

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  - Age: 12+
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  - Age: 7+
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  - Subject: Biology
  - Subject: English
  - Subject: Maths
  - Subject: Science
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  - Type: Past Test Paper
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